



THE COMPLETE GUIDE

Sharps Disposal Compliance Guide

Needles, syringes, pens & lancets — the OSHA and DOT rules, container sizing, and the simplest compliant way to dispose.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Sharps, handled right.

Any device that can puncture skin — a needle, a lancet, an insulin pen — is a regulated sharp the moment it is used. Mishandled sharps are the single most common source of needlestick injury and one of the most-cited waste violations in healthcare. This guide covers what counts as a sharp, the OSHA and DOT rules that govern containment and transport, how to size and fill a container, and how mail-back destruction closes the loop with a Certificate of Destruction.

The good news

You do not need a hauler contract or a scheduled truck to be compliant. A DOT-approved mail-back kit meets the same OSHA containment standard — you fill it, seal it, ship it, and we destroy it.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard (29 CFR 1910.1030) — container specs, labeling, placement, and annual training.
DOT	49 CFR — UN-rated packaging and shipping papers so a mail-back sharps container is compliant in transit.
State	Health-department rules on registration, transport, and tracking of regulated medical waste — these vary by state.
EPA	Where a sharp also carries hazardous drug residue (e.g. a chemo syringe), RCRA applies on top of OSHA.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Needles, syringes & injection devices

The core of the stream — anything hollow-bore or attached to a needle that has touched a patient.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Needles & hypodermic syringes
- Insulin pens & pen needles
- Auto-injectors (EpiPen and similar)
- Winged/butterfly sets, IV catheters

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Chemo-contaminated sharps (trace-chemo path)
- Non-sharp bloody waste (biohazard/RMW)
- Intact vials of drug (pharmaceutical waste)

THE RULE · OSHA 29 CFR 1910.1030 — sharps go directly into a closable, puncture-resistant, leak-proof, labeled container at the point of use.

DISPOSE WITH · A mail-back sharps kit — DOT-approved container with a prepaid return label.

Tip

Never recap, bend, or shear a needle by hand. Drop it straight into the container at the point of use.

WASTE STREAM 02

Lancets, blades & solid sharps

Solid sharps still puncture and still transmit bloodborne pathogens.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Lancets & fingerstick devices
- Scalpel & surgical blades
- Suture needles
- Broken glass with blood/OPIM

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Unused/clean glassware (general or recycling)
- Pharmaceutical vials without sharps

THE RULE · Same OSHA containment standard — a fill line at roughly three-quarters full, and no forcing sharps down.

DISPOSE WITH · Same sharps kit — solid and hollow sharps share one container.

Tip

Replace the container at the fill line. Overfilled containers are a top inspection finding.

WASTE STREAM 03

Container selection & fill

The right size keeps you compliant and keeps cost down.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- 1-2 qt for home use & low-volume offices
- 2-8 gal for clinics, urgent care & surgery
- Wall-mount brackets where required

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Milk jugs, coffee cans, or any non-approved container
- Red bags for loose sharps

THE RULE · Containers must be FDA-cleared, upright, closable, and labeled with the biohazard symbol.

DISPOSE WITH · Order the size that matches your fill rate — you should fill a container in weeks to months, not years.

Tip

Keep the container within arm's reach of where sharps are used — distance drives unsafe handling.

YOUR CHECKLIST

Your sharps compliance checklist.

- ☐ FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers at every point of use
- ☐ Containers labeled with the biohazard symbol and kept upright
- ☐ A written plan for replacing containers at the fill line
- ☐ Annual bloodborne pathogens training documented for staff
- ☐ DOT-compliant packaging whenever sharps ship off-site
- ☐ A Certificate of Destruction retained for every shipment
- ☐ Chemo and hazardous-drug sharps segregated to their own stream

QUESTIONS ABOUT SHARPS DISPOSAL

Sharps disposal FAQ.

Is mail-back sharps disposal OSHA-compliant?

Yes. The containers meet the OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard for containment and the packaging is DOT-approved for transport. Fill, seal, ship, and you receive a Certificate of Destruction.

What size sharps container do I need?

Home users and low-volume offices usually use 1–2 quart; clinics and urgent care use 2–8 gallon. Match the size to how fast you fill it — a container should be replaced at the fill line, not stored for years.

Can I put insulin pens and auto-injectors in the sharps container?

Yes. Insulin pens, pen needles, and auto-injectors such as EpiPens all belong in the sharps container and ship in the same mail-back kit.

Do sharps with chemo residue go in the same container?

No. A sharp contaminated with a hazardous chemotherapy drug follows the trace-chemo (RCRA) path in a yellow container, not the standard sharps stream.

How is the cost structured?

Per kit — the price includes the container, prepaid two-way shipping, destruction, and the Certificate of Destruction. There is no monthly fee and no contract.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Order a mail-back sharps kit sized for your volume. Fill the container at the point of use, seal it at the fill line, apply the prepaid UN-rated label, and hand it to any carrier. We destroy the contents and email your Certificate of Destruction — no truck, no route, no contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Needles & syringes	Mail-back sharps kit
Insulin pens & auto-injectors	Mail-back sharps kit
Lancets & blades	Mail-back sharps kit
Chemo-contaminated sharps	Trace-chemo (yellow) kit



Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

High sharps volume or multiple sites? We also run scheduled pickups and can standardize container sizes across every location — ask for a quote.

WHY CLINICS & FACILITIES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your sharps waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop